MACBETH · ACT 1

Act 1 check

Name _____ Date _____ Class _____ Score / 10

Start with the reading checkpoint: write one word from the text. Circle the letter of the best answer. Answer the last question in two or three sentences, with one detail from the text. Work without the book unless your teacher says otherwise.

Reading checkpoint. When Duncan embraces Banquo at Forres and holds him to his heart, what does Banquo say will be Duncan's own if he grows there?

Answer (one word from the text): _____

1. According to the wounded Captain, what did Macbeth do to the rebel Macdonwald?

- **A** Captured him and sent him to Duncan for trial
- **B** Drove him back by sea to the Western Isles
- **C** Split him open and set his head on the battlements
- **D** Wounded him and let him flee to the Norwegian camp

2. When Banquo first sees the witches on the heath, what makes him doubt that they are women?

- **A** Their deep and rough voices
- **B** Their beards
- **C** Their soldiers' armor
- **D** Their great height

3. Macbeth's first words in the play are "So foul and fair a day I have not seen." What makes this line unsettling in context?

- **A** It echoes the witches' chant before he has ever met them
- **B** It repeats the Captain's words to Duncan about the battle
- **C** It mocks Banquo, who has just complained about the storm
- **D** It answers the greeting the witches have just given him

4. When Macbeth stands lost in thought after Ross's news, what does Banquo suggest to the others is the cause?

- **A** He is worn out by the day's fighting
- **B** He pities the condemned Thane of Cawdor
- **C** He is still shaken by the witches
- **D** He is not yet used to his new honors

5. What does Lady Macbeth's advice when Macbeth reaches Inverness suggest is worrying her about him?

- **A** He has already told Banquo of the prophecy
- **B** His face shows his troubled thoughts too plainly
- **C** He has come home without the king's leave
- **D** He means to do the deed openly before the guests

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6. Alone, Macbeth says, "I have no spur To prick the sides of my intent, but only Vaulting ambition, which o'erleaps itself And falls on th' other." What does this riding image suggest?

- **A** His courage in battle will carry him through the deed
- **B** His loyalty to Duncan is urging him to act quickly
- **C** Ambition is his only motive, and it may overreach and fall
- **D** He plans to escape Inverness on horseback afterward

7. In Scene 7, what reason does Macbeth give his wife for proceeding no further?

- **A** Duncan is his kinsman and his guest
- **B** Banquo would surely suspect them
- **C** Chance may crown him without any act of his
- **D** He has newly won golden opinions from all sorts of people

8. Reread Lady Macbeth's line below. How does she use the idea of being "a man" to push Macbeth toward the murder? Support your answer with one detail from Scene 7.

“When you durst do it, then you were a man”

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MACBETH · ACT 2

Act 2 check

Name _____ Date _____ Class _____ Score / 10

Start with the reading checkpoint: write one word from the text. Circle the letter of the best answer. Answer the last question in two or three sentences, with one detail from the text. Work without the book unless your teacher says otherwise.

Reading checkpoint. On the unruly night of Duncan's murder, what does Lennox say were blown down where he and Macduff lay?

Answer (one word from the text): _____

1. Late at night, what does Banquo say Duncan has sent to Lady Macbeth?

- **A** A diamond, greeting her as a most kind hostess
- **B** A gold chain, thanking her for the evening's feast
- **C** A letter inviting her to his court at Forres
- **D** A ring, offered as a sign of his trust in Macbeth

2. Back from Duncan's chamber, Macbeth tells his wife about two sleepers who woke and prayed. What troubles him most about that moment?

- **A** He is sure they saw him and will accuse him at dawn
- **B** He fears that one sleeper's cry woke the whole house
- **C** He feels cut off from God's blessing by what he has done
- **D** He believes they were praying for Duncan's soul

3. Waiting alone, Lady Macbeth says, "I laid their daggers ready; He could not miss 'em." What has made her anxious just before this line?

- **A** She sees Banquo crossing the courtyard with a torch
- **B** Her husband's shout makes her fear the grooms woke first
- **C** The bell she was to ring has sounded too early
- **D** Loud knocking has begun at the castle's south gate

4. Before the dagger speech, what signal does Macbeth tell his servant Lady Macbeth should give when his drink is ready?

- **A** Knock twice at his chamber door
- **B** Set a lit torch in the window
- **C** Call his name from the stairway
- **D** Strike upon the bell

5. Back from Duncan's chamber, Macbeth says, "This is a sorry sight." What is he looking at when he says it?

- **A** His own blood-stained hands
- **B** The drugged grooms asleep by the door
- **C** Donalbain asleep in the second chamber
- **D** Duncan's body through the open door

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6. According to Macduff, where has Duncan's body been carried?

- **A** Scone
- **B** Forres
- **C** Colmekill
- **D** Saint Colme's Inch

7. When Lady Macbeth asks what the alarm bell means, why does Macduff at first refuse to tell her?

- **A** He already suspects her of a part in the crime
- **B** He thinks the news too terrible for a woman to hear
- **C** He wants Duncan's sons to be told before anyone else
- **D** He has sworn to Banquo to keep the deed secret

8. Reread Lady Macbeth's line below. How does it answer what Macbeth said about his bloody hand while she was away? Support your answer with his image from Scene 2.

"A little water clears us of this deed: How easy is it then!"

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MACBETH · ACT 3

Act 3 check

Name _____ Date _____ Class _____ Score / 10

Start with the reading checkpoint: write one word from the text. Circle the letter of the best answer. Answer the last question in two or three sentences, with one detail from the text. Work without the book unless your teacher says otherwise.

Reading checkpoint. At the banquet, how many trenched gashes does the First Murderer tell Macbeth that Banquo has on his head as he lies in a ditch?

Answer (one word from the text): _____

1. After Banquo leaves, until what hour does Macbeth tell his lords to be masters of their own time?

- **A** Seven at night
- **B** Midnight
- **C** Noon tomorrow
- **D** Sunset

2. Macbeth tells the murderers he could sweep Banquo away openly by his royal power. Why does he say he must not?

- **A** The law forbids a king to kill a thane without trial
- **B** Fleance would escape and raise an army against him
- **C** The witches warned him never to strike Banquo himself
- **D** He must keep the love of friends he shares with Banquo

3. As Banquo nears the palace, why does the Third Murderer expect him to come on foot?

- **A** His horse went lame on the road
- **B** He always sends his horse ahead with Fleance
- **C** Everyone walks the last mile to the palace gate
- **D** The park gate is too narrow for riders

4. Macbeth tells his wife, "We have scorch'd the snake, not kill'd it." What does this image suggest?

- **A** Their crime has left marks that will soon give them away
- **B** The danger to them is wounded but alive and can still strike
- **C** They should have poisoned Duncan instead of stabbing him
- **D** Macbeth regrets the harm he has done to Scotland

5. What is Banquo's last remark before the First Murderer strikes him?

- **A** That the road is darker than he expected
- **B** That it will rain tonight
- **C** That the feast must have begun without him
- **D** That he hears riders behind them

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6. After the guests leave, Macbeth explains how he learns what the thanes are doing. What does this reveal about his rule?

- **A** He relies on Lady Macbeth to watch the court for him
- **B** He trusts the Weird Sisters more than any of his men
- **C** He still counts on the loyalty of most thanes
- **D** He trusts none of his nobles and pays spies in their homes

7. Seeing the ghost, Macbeth cries, "Thou canst not say I did it. Never shake Thy gory locks at me." Which detail of the murderer's report, earlier in the scene, does the ghost's bloody head recall?

- **A** Banquo's body was thrown into the river
- **B** Banquo was stabbed through the heart
- **C** Banquo lies in a ditch with twenty gashes on his head
- **D** Banquo's head was cut off and hidden

8. Reread Macbeth's words to the murderers below. What remark is he answering, and what does he challenge the murderers to prove? Support your answer with one detail from Scene 1.

> *“Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men; As hounds, and greyhounds, mongrels, spaniels, curs,”*

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MACBETH · ACT 4

Act 4 check

Name _____ Date _____ Class _____ Score / 10

Start with the reading checkpoint: write one word from the text. Circle the letter of the best answer. Answer the last question in two or three sentences, with one detail from the text. Work without the book unless your teacher says otherwise.

Reading checkpoint. Which animal does Lady Macduff affectionately call her son while he argues with her about traitors and liars?

Answer (one word from the text): _____

1. Before the apparitions appear, what choice does the First Witch offer Macbeth?

- **A** To hear the answers from the witches or from their masters
- **B** To pay for the prophecy with gold or with blood
- **C** To learn his own fate or Banquo's fate first
- **D** To ask three questions or only one

2. After the messenger leaves, why does Lady Macduff decide that saying she has done no harm is a weak defense?

- **A** Her husband's flight makes the whole family traitors by law
- **B** Ross has warned her that the king suspects her
- **C** In this world doing harm is often praised and doing good is dangerous
- **D** The messenger told her the murderers have the king's warrant

3. When the second apparition appears, Macbeth says, "Had I three ears, I'd hear thee." What is he responding to?

- **A** The witches' order to listen but not speak
- **B** The apparition calling his name three times
- **C** Thunder that drowns out the apparition's voice
- **D** Lennox calling to him from outside the cave

4. In the show of eight kings, what does the last king carry?

- **A** A bloody dagger
- **B** A broken scepter
- **C** A branch of Birnam Wood
- **D** A glass that shows many more kings

5. What do Macduff's replies to Malcolm's first two confessions, lust and greed, show about him?

- **A** He will accept a flawed king to free Scotland from Macbeth
- **B** He has long suspected Malcolm of these very vices
- **C** He is secretly hoping to take the crown himself
- **D** He sees through the test and plays along with it

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6. According to the Doctor and Malcolm, what does the English king do for the sick?

- **A** He pays doctors to treat the poor at his court
- **B** He cures a disease called "the evil" by his touch
- **C** He prays for the sick but refuses to see them
- **D** He sends them to holy wells across England

7. When the murderers arrive, Macduff's son cries, "Thou liest, thou shag-ear'd villain!" What has the murderer just said?

- **A** That the boy's father is a traitor
- **B** That the boy's father is already dead
- **C** That the boy's mother must come with them
- **D** That Macbeth now owns Macduff's castle

8. Reread Lady Macduff's words below. What is she saying about her husband's flight, and how does Ross answer her charge? Support your answer with one detail from Scene 2.

> *"for the poor wren, The most diminutive of birds, will fight, Her young ones in her nest, against the owl."*

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MACBETH · ACT 5

Act 5 check

Name _____ Date _____ Class _____ Score / 10

Start with the reading checkpoint: write one word from the text. Circle the letter of the best answer. Answer the last question in two or three sentences, with one detail from the text. Work without the book unless your teacher says otherwise.

Reading checkpoint. Which plant, named alongside senna, does Macbeth wish for as a purgative drug that would scour the English out of Scotland?

Answer (one word from the text): _____

1. What has the Gentlewoman seen Lady Macbeth do in her sleep since Macbeth went to war?

- **A** Write on a paper, seal it, and go back to bed
- **B** Walk to the chamber where Duncan once slept
- **C** Call out for her husband at the castle gate
- **D** Climb to the battlements to watch for the army

2. Why does the Gentlewoman refuse to tell the Doctor what Lady Macbeth says in her sleep?

- **A** She has sworn to the queen to keep her secrets
- **B** She cannot make sense of the words she has heard
- **C** Without a witness to back her, repeating such words is dangerous
- **D** She suspects the Doctor of spying for Macbeth

3. Arming for battle, Macbeth tells the Doctor, "If thou couldst, doctor, cast The water of my land, find her disease, And purge it to a sound and pristine health." What disease of his land does he mean?

- **A** His wife's troubled mind
- **B** Famine spreading through the countryside
- **C** The witches' curse upon his crown
- **D** The English forces he wants scoured out

4. Marching toward Birnam, which person does Lennox say is certainly not with Malcolm's army?

- **A** Fleance
- **B** Menteith
- **C** Donalbain
- **D** Caithness

5. Alone on the field, Macbeth asks, "Why should I play the Roman fool, and die On mine own sword?" What reason does he give for refusing that end?

- **A** While enemies live, his sword does better on them
- **B** A king must die only by the hand of an equal
- **C** No man born of woman can kill him, so he cannot die
- **D** He wants to live to see the witches punished

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6. What does Macbeth's handling of his armor in Scene 3 suggest about him?

- **A** He is calm and fully trusts the prophecies
- **B** He means to lead the first charge out of the castle
- **C** He is quietly preparing to flee Dunsinane
- **D** He is restless and cannot settle on what he wants

7. What does Ross tell old Siward that lets him accept his son's death with pride?

- **A** His son died holding Malcolm's banner
- **B** His son had his wounds on the front
- **C** His son was the first to enter the castle
- **D** His son died beside Macduff in the charge

8. Reread Angus's image below. What does it suggest about Macbeth as king? Support your answer with the other image of clothing that a Scottish lord uses for Macbeth earlier in Scene 2.

> *"now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief."*

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